

Devon Ruiz

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Biological scientist with over a decade of research experience including extensive experience in cellular immunology, oncology and microbiology. Experience with in vivo models, animal handling experimentation, and dissection. Experience in biological and biochemical assay development, molecular biology, and gene expression profiling. Skilled in the design and construction of gene reporter and protein expression systems, as well as biochemical structure-function analyses.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Microbiology

University of California, Davis

Expected December 2025

Davis, CA

Engineer in Training Certification

State of California

March 2023

Sacramento, CA

Bachelor of Science in Molecular Cellular Developmental Biology

University of California, Santa Cruz

June 2022

Santa Cruz, CA

EXPERIENCE

Researcher

UC Davis Department of Microbiology

September 2023 - Present

Davis, CA

- Designed and constructed an experimental system using confocal microscopy for generating quantitative in situ real time data of bacterial horizontal gene transfer kinetics in simulated aquatic environments.
- Conducted numerical analyses of data sets for establishing governing equations of mathematical models focused on quantifying rates and distribution of bacteria.
- Profiled metabolic processes of mixed bacterial populations from wastewater using degenerate primer designs for profiling gene regulation and using GC/MS for profiling changes in intracellular metabolic intermediates.
- Served as research advisor for undergraduate student research group competing in the US EPA people prosperity and planet (P3) design competition for sustainability.
- Presented research findings at international conferences to fellow researchers, company representatives, and students.

Teaching Assistant

Departments of Microbiology and Civil and Environmental Engineering

September 2023 - May 2024

Davis, CA

- Lead course discussions and laboratory sections in Microbiology and Engineering for 200+ students.
- Guided students in writing engineering design reports and developing experimental plans for laboratory projects.

Research Associate 3

Dynavax Technologies

September 2023 - February 2024

Emeryville, CA

- Developed functional bioassays using monocytes and monocyte-derived macrophages for characterizing a small-molecule modulator of toll-like receptor signaling (TLRs) in cells from human, mouse and diseased tissues.
- Evaluated functional readouts of biological responses using flow cytometry, ELISA, and gene expression profiling, to evaluate changes in NF κ B signaling under inflammatory responses.
- Developed primary lymphocyte bioassays for screening novel structured oligo-nucleotides as modulators of innate immune responses.

Research Associate 2

DNAX Research Institute

September 2022 - August 2023

Palo Alto, CA

- Developed a biochemical assay for high throughput screening of small-molecule inhibitors against Chk-1 kinase as combination cancer therapeutics with DNA damaging agents.
- Validated therapeutic efficacy of lead candidate molecule in developed bioassay systems and compared to gene knockouts with siRNA using Western blotting, gene expression profiling, and flow cytometry.
- Developed osteoclast differentiation bioassay from primary lymphocytes for studying osteoporosis.
- Conducted protein and gene expression profiling of biological markers during adaptive and innate immune responses.